JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a staff frontend engineer with 12 years of experience building user-facing products that scale. I've led frontend architecture decisions at several startups and mid-sized companies, mentored junior developers, and shipped features used by millions. I'm particularly interested in performance optimization and building resilient systems that don't break when things go wrong.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Frontend Engineer

Velocity Labs

velocitylabs.io

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the frontend architecture redesign that reduced bundle size by 40% and improved Core Web Vitals scores across all products. Established coding standards and conducted code reviews for a team of 6 engineers, catching critical accessibility and performance issues before production. Mentored 2 junior developers through their first year, resulting in both being promoted to mid-level positions. Migrated a legacy Angular application to React over 6 months, maintaining feature parity while improving developer productivity.

Senior Frontend Engineer

Digital Canvas Ltd

digitalcanvas.co

London, United Kingdom

July 2017 - February 2021

Owned the complete frontend rebuild of the company's flagship design collaboration tool, implementing real-time features using WebSockets that supported 500+ concurrent users. Reduced application loading time from 8 seconds to 2 seconds through aggressive code splitting, lazy loading, and image optimization strategies. Built an internal component library used across 3 product teams, documented extensively, and trained teams on best practices for maintainability. Introduced automated performance testing into the CI/CD pipeline, catching regressions before they reached production.

Frontend Engineer

Nexus Interactive

nexus-interactive.net

Glasgow, United Kingdom

January 2012 - June 2017

Built responsive web applications serving 2 million monthly users across desktop and mobile platforms using jQuery, then transitioned to React as the framework matured. Implemented complex data visualization dashboards using D3.js that displayed real-time analytics for enterprise clients. Collaborated with UX designers and backend engineers to deliver features on tight deadlines while maintaining code quality. Established unit testing practices using Jasmine and later Jest, increasing test coverage from 15% to 75%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

2008 - 2012

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Frameworks: JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Vue.js, HTML5, CSS3

State Management: Redux, Zustand, Context API, Vuex

Frontend Tools: Webpack, Vite, Babel, ESLint, Prettier

Testing: Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Playwright, Vitest

Performance Optimization: Code splitting, lazy loading, image optimization, Core Web Vitals, Lighthouse

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 compliance, semantic HTML, ARIA, screen reader testing

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Other: REST APIs, GraphQL, WebSockets, responsive design, CSS-in-JS, Storybook